

A net-zero-impact water utility?

WSC's 2019 promise of 4 billion litres less groundwater, tested against its own production reports

THE CLAIM

“The Corporation’s ground water abstraction will be reduced by 4 billion litres per year.”

Water Services Corporation, news release, 2 April 2019

Same release: “much more water with less energy”.

Baseline and date are not stated; we use 2016, the last pre-project WSC report we could read in full.

PLEDGE

NOT MEASURABLE

*No baseline,
no date.*

NOT
MEASURABLE

NOT YET
DUE

ON
TRACK

OFF
TRACK

MET

MISSED

MAIN RESULTS

–2.0 million m³

Groundwater, 2025 vs 2016

WSC borehole production fell from 13.5 to 11.5 million m³: about half of the pledged 4.0.

0.4

Only 0.4 million m³ in 2024

2023 and 2024 were barely below 2016; one year is not yet a trend.

+50%

More desalination

RO output rose from 18.6 to 27.9 million m³ between 2016 and 2025.

–33%

Needed to stay flat

Specific energy would have to fall by a third for RO electricity not to rise.

No total

WSC’s electricity use

Total kWh by year was not found; RO is only part of it.

FAIR TO SAY

Groundwater’s share of WSC production fell from 42% to 29% while total production grew by about 23%. Lower energy use and water security are sound goals; the question is whether the promises can be checked.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The baseline year and date behind “4 billion litres”.

☐ Total electricity use (kWh) by year.

☐ Whether all project components are complete.

☐ Specific energy of each RO plant by year.